Self-Advocacy Communication Organizer

1 Identify the Need

What do I need?

(Be specific about what information or support you're seeking.)

Why do I need this information or support?

(Explain the importance or purpose of your request.)

2 Know Your Rights or Entitlements

What are my rights or entitlements?

(What laws, policies, or guidelines apply to your situation? Consider any protections you may have.)

What support or accommodations am I entitled to?

(This could relate to school, work, or personal situations.)

3 Prepare Your Message

Who do I need to talk to?

(Identify the person or organization that can help with your request.)

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What do I need to say?

(Prepare a clear, direct message to explain your needs.)

4 Ask Clear Questions

What do I want to know or ask for?

(Be specific in your request so that the person you're speaking to understands.)

How will I ask for clarification if I don’t understand?

(Plan a phrase to ask for more information, e.g., "Could you explain that again?" or "Can you provide an example?")

5 Active Listening and Response

How will I actively listen to the response?

(This is about being present and attentive, avoiding interruptions.)

What questions might I ask to clarify the response?

(Consider follow-up questions based on the answer you receive.)

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6 Confirm the Outcome

What is the next step?

(Clarify any action items, deadlines, or follow-up steps.)

How will I follow up if necessary?

(Write down any plans for following up or checking in.)

7 Reflection

How did the conversation go?

(Reflect on how comfortable you were, if you got the information you needed, and what went well.)

What will I do differently next time?

(Consider what you might adjust in your approach next time.)

This graphic organizer helps structure communication, especially when advocating for specific information. It keeps the conversation focused and ensures all steps—preparation, asking questions, listening, and following up—are taken into account.

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